

RH08

1857 in Rajasthan; Peasant and Tribal Movements

About 2 questions a paper, and they are predictable. Bijolia has been asked in 2016 and 2024, the Eki movement in 2023, Neemuchana in 2021. Every one of those was a leader-place-year question. Three separate revolts sit inside one chapter. In 1857 the sepoys rose and the princes stood with the British. From 1897 the peasants rose against the thikanas. From 1883 the Bhils and Meenas rose against both. Learn them as three stories, not one list — the leaders, the places and the years never overlap.

1857 & the People's Movements

1857 cantonments

- Nasirabad 28 May
- Neemuch 3 June
- Erinpura 21 Aug
- Kota 15 Oct
- Deoli
- Kherwara & Beawar — quiet

Peasant — north

- Neemuchana 1925 Alwar
- Sikar/Shekhawati 1935
- Dudhwa Khara 1946
- Dabra 1947

1857 people

- Khushal Singh, Auwa
- Lala Jaidayal & Mehrab Khan, Kota
- Monck Mason & Major Burton killed
- AGG G.P. Lawrence

Tribal

- Govind Giri, Samp Sabha 1883
- Mangarh 1913
- Motilal Tejawat, Eki 1921
- Meena Mahasabha 1933

Peasant — Mewar side

- Bijolia 1897-1941
- Begun 1921-23
- Bundi/Dabi 1923

Leaders to fix

- Vijay Singh Pathik
- Manikya Lal Verma
- Ram Narayan Chaudhary
- Nayanuram Sharma

Why 1857 looked different in Rajputana

Understand the shape before the dates. In Rajputana the revolt of 1857 was a SEPOY revolt, not a princes' revolt. The British had six cantonments in the

region. The sepoys in them mutinied. But almost every ruler stayed loyal to the British — and that is why the rising here was crushed comparatively fast.

There were six cantonments. Learn them by name, because a standard question asks which one did NOT revolt.

- Nasirabad (Ajmer) — revolted.
- Neemuch — revolted.
- Erinpura (Pali) — revolted.
- Deoli (Tonk) — revolted.
- Kherwara (Udaipur) — did NOT revolt.
- Beawar — did NOT revolt.

On the British side the man in charge was George Patrick Lawrence, Agent to the Governor-General for Rajputana, sitting at Mount Abu. The Ajmer treasury was moved for safety during the crisis.

Rulers who sided with the British in 1857

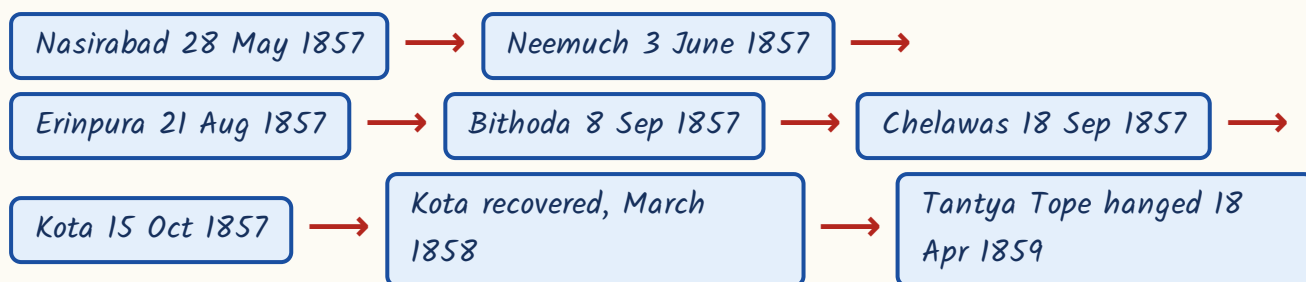
State	Ruler
Jaipur	Ram Singh II
Jodhpur	Takht Singh
Udaipur	Swaroop Singh
Bikaner	Sardar Singh
Kota	Ram Singh
Karauli	Narendra Singh

Kherwara and Beawar are counted among the six but never mutinied. Questions phrase this as 'which cantonment is counted among the six but saw no mutiny' — the answer they want is Kherwara.

The chronology of 1857 in Rajasthan

This is an ordering question waiting to happen. Fix the sequence by month: May, June, August, September, October. Then March next year for the recovery of Kota, and April 1859 for Tantya Tope.

1857-59 in Rajasthan, in order



- Nasirabad, 28 May 1857 — the 15th and 30th Native Infantry mutinied and marched to Delhi. This is where the revolt in Rajasthan begins.
- Neemuch, 3 June 1857 — the sepoys moved on Delhi via Chittor; Mohammad Ali Beg is remembered here.
- Erinpura, 21 August 1857 — the Jodhpur Legion rose with the cry 'Chalo Delhi, Maro Firangi'.

YAAD RAKHO

NNEK — Nasirabad, Neemuch, Erinpura, Kota. Four letters, four centres, correct order. Auwa's two battles sit between Erinpura and Kota.

Auwa and Kota — the only two places the British really lost control

Auwa is a thikana of Marwar. Its Thakur, Khushal Singh Champawat, gave shelter to the Erinpura mutineers and then beat the Jodhpur state army in the field. Two battles: Bithoda on 8 September 1857 and Chelawas on 18 September 1857.

At Auwa the rebels killed Monck Mason, the Political Agent of Jodhpur, and hung his head at the fort gate. That single act is why Auwa is remembered — and why it is the standard 'which officer was killed where' question.

Kota is the bigger episode. On 15 October 1857 the Kota troops rose under Lala Jaidayal, a Kayastha, and Mehrab Khan. They killed Major Burton, the Political Agent. The rebels held the city for about six months. General H.G. Roberts recovered Kota only in March 1858.

The two big centres — who, what, when

Centre	Leader(s)	British officer killed	Key dates
Auwa (Marwar)	Thakur Khushal Singh Champawat	Monck Mason, PA Jodhpur	Bithoda 8 Sep, Chelawas 18 Sep 1857
Kota	Lala Jaidayal, Mehrab Khan	Major Burton, PA Kota	Rose 15 Oct 1857; recovered Mar 1858

TRAP

Never swap the two officers. Monck Mason died at Auwa. Major Burton died at Kota. A common wrong pair printed in negative questions is 'Deoli - killing of Major Burton'.

After the main risings came Tantya Tope. He entered Rajasthan through Banswara and Pratapgarh, was defeated near Bhilwara and again near Sikar, and was finally hanged at Sipri on 18 April 1859.

Why the peasants rose — lag, begar and the thikana

Now shift forty years forward. The peasant movements have nothing to do with 1857. Their cause is economic: the jagirdar or thikanedar taxed the cultivator for everything.

'Lag' means a cess. 'Bag' means a levy in kind. 'Begar' or 'bethbegar' means forced unpaid labour. Bijolia alone had 84 kinds of lag on 84 villages. When the state added yet another one, the village stopped paying — and that is a movement.

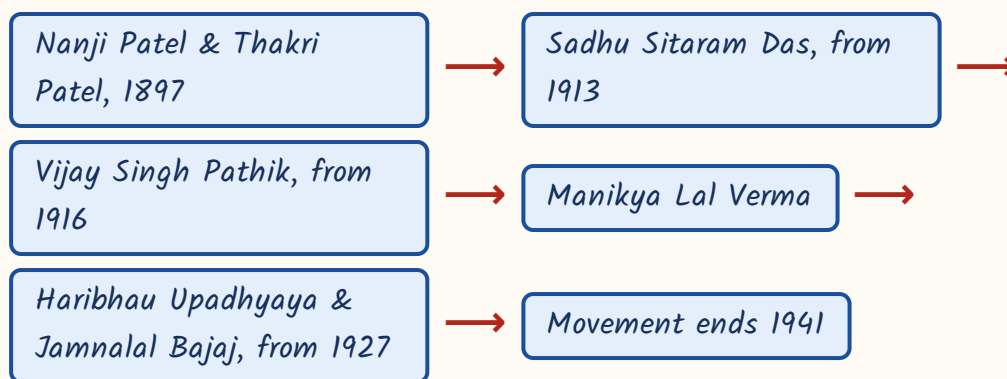
- Chanwari lag (1903) — a tax on every marriage in the village. This is the spark at Bijolia.
- Talwar Bandhai — a levy taken when a new thikanedar succeeded.
- Begar / bethbegar — unpaid forced labour on the thikana's land.
- The demand in every one of these movements is the same: abolish the illegal cesses and the begar.

Bijolia — India's longest peasant movement

Bijolia is the centrepiece of this chapter. Understand the setting: Bijolia was a first-class thikana of Mewar state, and it lies in today's Bhilwara district. The movement ran from 1897 to 1941 — forty-four years, the longest peasant movement in modern India.

Its leadership changed four times, and RPSC asks the sequence. Learn it as a chain, not as a set.

Bijolia — the leadership chain, 1897 to 1941



Vijay Singh Pathik is the name that carries this chapter into the next one. His real name was Bhoop Singh Gurjar, and he was born at Guthawali in Bulandshahr — an outsider who became Rajasthan's leading peasant organiser. He founded the Rajasthan Seva Sangh at Wardha in 1919 and edited Rajasthan Kesari.

- 84 villages, 84 types of lag — the famous 'chaurasi' framing.
- Publicised nationally by 'Pratap' of Kanpur, edited by Ganesh Shankar Vidyarthi.
- Also carried by 'Abhyudaya' and 'Bharat Mitra' of Allahabad.
- Gandhi sent Mahadev Desai to study the movement on the ground.
- Manikya Lal Verma began his public life here, wrote the song 'Panchhida', and later led the Mewar Prajamandal.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2016 and again in 2024 — when did the Bijolia peasant movement begin? Answer: 1897. The paired statement question adds that it ran to 1941 and that Vijay Singh Pathik led it from 1916.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2024 — the real name of Vijay Singh Pathik? Answer: Bhoop Singh.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2018 — which two Hindi newspapers carried the Bijolia peasants' cause to a national audience? Answer: Abhyudaya and Bharat Mitra.

The other peasant movements — one table, learn it cold

Begun is Bijolia's twin — same region, same grievances, a few years later. Ram Narayan Chaudhary led it from 1921 to 1923. In the Govindpura firing of July 1923 two peasants, Rupaji and Kripaji Dhakad, were killed. The settlement that ended it was so favourable to the peasants that the British officer Trench sneered at it as the 'Bolshevik Agreement'.

Bijolia vs Begun — the two Mewar-side movements

Bijolia	Begun (Bengu)
1897-1941, the longest in India	1921-1923, short and sharp
Bhilwara district; thikana of Mewar	Chittorgarh side; thikana of Mewar
Pathik, Sitaram Das, Manikya Lal Verma	Ram Narayan Chaudhary
Trigger: Chanwari lag, 1903	Martyrs: Rupaji and Kripaji, Govindpura 1923
National publicity via Pratap, Abhyudaya	Settlement mocked as the 'Bolshevik Agreement'

Peasant movements — movement, leader, place, year

Movement	Leader	Place / state	Year
Bijolia	Vijay Singh Pathik (after Sitaram Das)	Bijolia thikana, Mewar — Bhilwara	1897-1941
Begun (Bengu)	Ram Narayan Chaudhary	Begun, Mewar	1921-1923
Barad / Bundi	Pandit Nayanuram Sharma	Dabi, Bundi state	Dabi kand 2 Apr 1923

Movement	Leader	Place / state	Year
Neemuchana	Peasants of the Alwar hills	Neemuchana, Alwar state	14 May 1925
Sikar / Shekhawati Jat	Sikarwati Jat Kisan Panchayat; Thakur Deshraj	Kudan, Sikar	Kudan kand 25 Apr 1935
Dudhwa Khara	Kumbharam Arya, Raghuvar Dayal Goyal	Bikaner state	From 1946
Marwar Kisan Sabha	Marwar Kisan Sabha leadership	Dabra, Jodhpur state	Dabra kand 13 Mar 1947

Two of these produced martyrs whose names get matched in questions. At Dabi in Bundi, Nanakji Bhil was killed on 2 April 1923 — that incident is called 'Rajasthan ka Jallianwala Bagh'. In the Raisinghnagar firing of the Dudhwa Khara movement, Birbal Singh died.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2021 — the Neemuchana firing, which Gandhi condemned in Young India as 'double-dyed dyerism', took place in which state? Answer: Alwar. The troops were Maharaja Jai Singh's, on 14 May 1925.

YAAD RAKHO

Martyr-to-place: Rupaji and Kripaji = Begun. Nanakji Bhil = Dabi, Bundi. Birbal Singh = Raisinghnagar, Bikaner. Three names, three places — this is a direct matching set.

The tribal movements — Bhil, Eki, Meena, Mer

The tribal movements start earlier and are religious-reformist before they are political. Govind Giri — usually called Govind Guru — was born in 1858 at Bansiya, also given as Bedsa, in Dungarpur. In 1883 he founded the Samp

Sabha, an organisation for the moral and social uplift of the Bhils. He preached 33 rules and lit a dhuni, a sacred fire, on Mangarh hill.

The Samp Sabha's followers were called Bhagats — so this is also known as the Bhagat movement. It grew into a demand for an end to forced labour and heavy levies, and the British read that as sedition.

On 17 November 1913, British forces under Major S. Bailey opened fire on the Bhils gathered on Mangarh hill, on the Banswara-Gujarat border. About 1,500 Bhils were killed. Mangarh is called the 'Adivasi Jallianwala Bagh' — and it happened six years BEFORE Jallianwala Bagh itself.

The second tribal movement is the Eki movement, also called the Bhomat movement. Its leader was Motilal Tejawat, an Oswal of Kolyari village in Jhadol, Udaipur state. He began in 1921. His slogan was 'Na Hakim, Na Hukum' — no officer, no order. The Bhils called him 'Bavji' and he is remembered as 'Adivasiyon ka Masiha'.

- Tejawat's charter of 21 demands was called 'Mewar ki Pukar'.
- The Neemda (Nimda) firing of 7 March 1922 broke the movement's back.
- The Palchitariya firing of 1923 finished it.
- Tejawat surrendered in 1929 on Gandhi's advice.

Tribal movements — movement, leader, place, year

Movement	Leader	Place	Year
Bhagat / Bhil movement — Samp Sabha	Govind Giri (Govind Guru)	Founded in Dungarpur; base at Mangarh hill	1883
Mangarh massacre	Govind Giri's followers; firing by Major S. Bailey	Mangarh, Banswara-Gujarat border	17 Nov 1913
Eki / Bhomat movement	Motilal Tejawat	Kolyari, Jhadol — Udaipur state	From 1921

Movement	Leader	Place	Year
Neemda firing	Motilal Tejawat's Bhils	Neemda, Mewar	7 Mar 1922
Meena movement	Meena Kshatriya Mahasabha	Jaipur state; Bagawas conference	1933; Bagawas 28 Oct 1946
Mer revolt	Suppressed by Colonel Hall	Merwara, Aravalli tract	1820-21

The Meena movement is a different kind of fight — a fight against a label. The Meenas were listed under the Criminal Tribes Act of 1924 and the Jaipur Jarayam Peshwa Act of 1930, which forced them to report to the police. The Meena Kshatriya Mahasabha was formed in 1933 to resist this. At the Bagawas conference on 28 October 1946 about 26,000 Meena chowkidars resigned in protest. The Act was repealed in 1952.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2023 — Motilal Tejawat, leader of the Eki movement, belonged to which community and village? Answer: an Oswal of Kolyari. The paired statement question adds the slogan 'Na Hakim, Na Hukum' and the Neemda firing of 1922.

TRAP

Two 'Jallianwala Bagh' labels, two different events. Dabi kand (Bundi, 2 Apr 1923, Nanakji Bhil) = 'Rajasthan ka Jallianwala Bagh'. Mangarh (17 Nov 1913) = 'Adivasi Jallianwala Bagh'.

TRAP

The Eki movement was NOT launched by the Mewar Prajamandal — the Prajamandal came only in 1938, seventeen years later. That false option appears in negative questions.

CURRENT LINK

Current link (as of September 2026): Mangarh Dham remains in the news. The Prime Minister described it as a national monument at a public event on 1 November 2022, but in August 2026 the Union Culture Ministry told Parliament that national monument status under the AMASR Act, 1958 could not be granted because modern construction at the site has removed its archaeological integrity. Mangarh is also central to Janjatiya Gaurav Diwas each 15 November.

REVISION RECAP

1. Six cantonments in 1857: Nasirabad, Neemuch, Erinpura, Deoli, Kherwara, Beawar — the last two stayed quiet.
2. Revolt begins Nasirabad, 28 May 1857; 15th and 30th Native Infantry march to Delhi.
3. Neemuch 3 June 1857; Erinpura 21 August 1857 — Jodhpur Legion, 'Chalo Delhi, Maro Firangi'.
4. Auwa: Thakur Khushal Singh Champawat; Bithoda 8 Sep, Chelawas 18 Sep 1857; Monck Mason killed.
5. Kota: 15 Oct 1857, Lala Jaidayal and Mehrab Khan; Major Burton killed; recovered by Gen. H.G. Roberts, March 1858.
6. AGG in 1857 was George Patrick Lawrence at Mount Abu; the princes stayed loyal.
7. Tantya Tope entered via Banswara-Pratapgarh; hanged at Sipri, 18 April 1859.
8. Bijolia 1897-1941 — longest peasant movement in India; Mewar thikana in Bhilwara district; 84 villages, 84 lag.
9. Bijolia chain: Nanji-Thakri Patel 1897, Sitaram Das 1913, Pathik 1916, Manikya Lal Verma, Upadhyaya-Bajaj 1927.
10. Vijay Singh Pathik = Bhoop Singh Gurjar; Rajasthan Seva Sangh, Wardha 1919; editor of Rajasthan Kesari.
11. Chanwari lag 1903 = marriage tax at Bijolia; Talwar Bandhai = succession levy.
12. Begun 1921-23, Ram Narayan Chaudhary; Rupaji-Kripaji killed at Govindpura 1923; 'Bolshevik Agreement'.
13. Dabi kand, Bundi, 2 April 1923 — Nanakji Bhil killed — 'Rajasthan ka Jallianwala Bagh'; leader Pt. Nayanuram Sharma.
14. Neemuchana, Alwar, 14 May 1925 — Gandhi's 'double-dyed dyerism' in Young India.
15. Sikarwati Jat Kisan Panchayat; Kudan kand 25 April 1935; Thakur Deshraj and the Jat Mahasabha.

16. Dudhwa Khara from 1946 in Bikaner — Kumbharam Arya; Birbal Singh died at Raisinghnagar. Dabra kand, Jodhpur, 13 Mar 1947.
17. Govind Giri, b. 1858 Dungarpur; Samp Sabha 1883; 33 rules; dhuni on Mangarh hill.
18. Mangarh massacre 17 Nov 1913, firing under Major S. Bailey, about 1,500 Bhils dead — 'Adivasi Jallianwala Bagh'.
19. Motilal Tejawat, Oswal of Kolyari (Jhadol); Eki/Bhomat from 1921; 'Na Hakim, Na Hukum'; 'Mewar ki Pukar' = 21 demands; Neemda firing 7 Mar 1922, Palchitariya 1923; surrendered 1929 on Gandhi's advice.
20. Meenas under Criminal Tribes Act 1924 and Jaipur Jarayam Pesha Act 1930; Mahasabha 1933; Bagawas 28 Oct 1946; repealed 1952.